

A TODDLING TOURIST TOWN AGAIN

Chicago saw post-pandemic high in visitors last year, and now city will try to capitalize on momentum. **Chicagoland, Page 3**

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Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

GOP bill takes aim at Medicaid

Hundreds of thousands of Illinois residents could lose coverage under House Republican proposals

By **Lisa Schencker**
Chicago Tribune

State health care leaders are warning that proposed cuts to federal Medicaid funding could have devastating consequences — potentially resulting in a loss of

health care coverage for hundreds of thousands of people in Illinois.

House Republicans have been talking for months about potentially slashing Medicaid, but this week they unveiled, for the first time, language of a bill outlining exactly how they plan to do that.

On Wednesday, those plans moved closer to reality, with the House Energy and Commerce Committee advancing the measure.

It's unclear exactly how much federal money Illinois could lose under the current proposals, but a number of the provisions would directly affect Medicaid funding in Illinois. The bill includes work requirements for people on Medicaid, and would restrict

taxes that states including Illinois now impose on providers to help raise money for Medicaid. It would also cut funding for states that offer health care coverage to undocumented immigrants, such as Illinois — a provision that could trigger an end of coverage for more than 770,000 Illinois residents who gained it under the Affordable Care Act's expansion of Medicaid. The bill would reduce federal

Medicaid spending by \$625 billion over 10 years, according to preliminary estimates by the Congressional Budget Office. It's part of a larger Republican plan to cut federal spending to help pay for new and existing tax cuts and enhanced border and national security.

"We're going to root out fraud,

Turn to Medicaid, Page 5



ARMANDO L. SANCHEZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Beyoncé fans Soldier on

Amauri Allen, 23, left, and Jamel Harried, 24, of South Carolina, dance outside Soldier Field while waiting in line to attend the first night of Beyoncé's "Cowboy Carter" Chicago tour stop on Thursday. The tour got off to a rocky start as potentially severe weather moving through the area delayed the start to the three-day concert stand. But with shows scheduled for Saturday and Sunday, the Tribune answers some common questions the Beyhive may have before heading out to Soldier Field. **Chicagoland, Page 2**

Justices seem split on birthright citizenship

By **Mark Sherman and Lindsay Whitehurst**
Associated Press

WASHINGTON — The Supreme Court seemed intent Thursday on keeping a block on President Donald Trump's restrictions on birthright citizenship while looking for a way to scale back nationwide court orders.

It was unclear what such a deci-

sion might look like, but a majority of the court expressed concerns about what would happen if the Trump administration were allowed, even temporarily, to deny citizenship to children born to people who are in the United States illegally.

The justices heard arguments in the Trump administration's emergency appeals over lower court orders that have kept the citizenship restrictions on hold

across the country. Nationwide, or universal, injunctions have emerged as an important check on Trump's efforts to remake the government and a mounting frustration to the Republican president and his allies.

Judges have issued 40 nationwide injunctions since Trump began his second term in January, Solicitor General D. John Sauer told the court at the start of more than two hours of arguments.

Birthright citizenship is among several issues, many related to immigration, that the administration has asked the court to address on an emergency basis.

The justices are also considering the Trump administration's pleas to end humanitarian parole for more than 500,000 people from Cuba, Haiti, Nicaragua and Venezuela and to strip other

Turn to Justices, Page 9

Deal may cost city another \$15.5M

Aldermen to decide on meter settlement

By **Jake Sheridan**
Chicago Tribune

Former Mayor Richard M. Daley's infamous parking meters deal could soon cost Chicagoans another pile of cash.

City attorneys are recommending aldermen approve a deal to settle for \$15.5 million three long-standing disputes with the company that owns the meters, Chicago Parking Meters LLC. The proposal is part of the agenda released Thursday for the City Council's upcoming Finance Committee meeting, where aldermen will also consider a package of police misconduct settlements totaling \$62 million — an amount set to take the city well beyond its 2025 police settlement budget.

The parking meter settlement amount is far below the \$322 million the company initially demanded to meet how much it said it lost because of city actions, and the \$120.7 million figure city appraisers argued during arbitration was a more accurate estimate. Leaders in Mayor Brandon Johnson's administration touted the payout as a good deal amid the broader bad one that city leaders have long tried and failed to get out of.

"We look forward to closing this chapter and focusing on a more constructive relationship with CPM moving ahead," Chief Financial Officer Jill Jaworski wrote in a statement

Turn to Meters, Page 2

■ Aldermen will consider \$62 million more in Chicago police misconduct settlements. **Chicagoland, Page 4**

Pope's identity resonates in Chicago

Leo's patchwork background, including Peruvian, Black Creole links, reflects cultural complexity

By **Nell Salzman and Carolyn Stein**
Chicago Tribune

When Robert Francis Prevost spoke in Spanish to his crowd of supporters for the first time in St. Peter's Square last week, Edgewater resident Julio Fernandez said it made him tear up.

"I've lived in Chicago for many years. And that he is from both places makes me double proud," Fernandez, 74, a retired doctor

from northern Peru, said.

Prevost, now Pope Leo XIV, has a patchwork background that speaks to the melting pot that is the United States — and his birthplace, the city of Chicago. Though he worked in Peru for 20 years and has a deep bond to the country, Prevost's father was French and Italian and his mother was of Spanish descent, according to a Vatican news release. Genealogists would later unearth that his maternal grandparents were

Creole people from Louisiana — an often mixed-race cultural identity linked to French, Spanish, African and Indigenous heritages.

As the first pope from the United States, his worldly connections and history have brought a sense of familiarity to Chicagoans who share his identity, and even those who don't, since the news was announced, said Verónica Bustamante, the consul general of Peru for Chicago, as she sat their office on Michigan Avenue.

"The pope is more Peruvian than the potato," she joked, referencing

Turn to Pope, Page 4



Julio Fernandez, a retired doctor from northern Peru, prays before the start of Mass at St. Stanislaus Kostka School's chapel in Chicago on Tuesday. **STACEY WESCOTT/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

TODAY'S WEATHER



High **88** Low **54**

Complete Chicagoland forecast on Page 12

\$4.00 city and suburbs and elsewhere
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